

The Manifest Awakening of Vajra-Essence: A King of Tantras Drawn from the Vows of the Web of Ḍākinīs of Hevajra

Hevajraḍḍākinījālavratāt Vajrahṛdayābhisambodhi · Toh 418 · Derge Kangyur

ཀུན་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་ཀྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་པ་ལས་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་ཀྱི་པ་མོ་དེའི་པར་བརྒྱ་ཆགས་པ་

Toh 418 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Tibetan as Dorje Nyingpo Ngönpar Jangchubpa (ཏོར་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་ཀྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་པ་ལས་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་ཀྱི་པ་མོ་དེའི་པར་བརྒྱ་ཆགས་པ་), rendered in English as "The Manifest Awakening of Vajra-Essence," and associated in Sanskrit with the Hevajra tantric cycle. It belongs to the class of Yoganiruttara or Highest Yoga Tantras and forms part of the broader Hevajra (Kye Dorje) corpus, being drawn from the vows of the web of ḍākinīs of Hevajra. The text concerns ritual procedures including fire offerings, the construction and consecration of sacred maṇḍalas, the purification and animation of images through the summoning of buddhas from space, and the enumeration of mantra recitation counts for different classes of beings such as gods, asuras, and mantra practitioners. As Toh 418 in the Kangyur, it sits within the collection of Buddha's word preserved in the Tibetan canon, specifically among the tantric scriptures, and takes the form of a dialogue between the Blessed One and the bodhisattva Vajra-Essence, who petitions the Buddha to explain these esoteric teachings in their proper sequence.

Seven hundred thousand for the asuras (Skt. asura), two hundred thousand for the gods, one hundred thousand for the mantra practitioners.

Here ends the tantra called "The Manifest Awakening of Vajra-Essence," the king of tantras drawn from the vows of the web of ḍākinīs of Hevajra. This is its conclusion.

Vajra-Essence then made this supplication:

Blessed One, Vajra-Essence, I myself —
you who are all buddhas gathered into one,
the very good characteristic of perfect consecration:
please explain it in its proper sequence.

The Blessed One then declared:

As has been said, having performed the fire offering,
one erects the sacred maṇḍala,
then beforehand one purifies the images,

and after making preparations and the like,
all the buddhas residing in space
are fully drawn into the images at the heart.
The yogin who sees clearly, equal to his chosen deity,
has gone to the far shore of mantra.

Om vajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Om vajra dhūpe āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Om vajra dīpe
āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Om vajra gandhe āḥ hūṃ svāhā. Om vajra naivedye āḥ hūṃ
svāhā.

The completion of the variegated hūṃ syllable,
and the offering of flowers and the rest:
through the ritual sequence of the higher tantra,
[offer] the water of welcome and foot-washing as before.
For pacifying rites, the fire pit is round;
for enriching rites, it is square.
For slaying rites, it is said to be triangular.
For this same purpose the remainder is accomplished here.
One cubit and a half a cubit in measure:
above and below for pacifying rites.
One and a half cubits and one full cubit:
above and below is prescribed for enriching rites.
Twenty finger-widths, or half of that,
above and below for slaying rites as well.
For pacifying, the colour becomes white;
for enriching, it is likewise yellow.
For slaying, the colour is black;
for subjugating, it is well known to be red.
For subjugating, one draws in accordingly;
for slaying, it is as with aversion and so forth.
For pacifying, sesame; for enriching, curds;
for slaying, thorns — it is likewise so;
for aversion and the like, thorns are also prescribed.
For subjugating and drawing in, the utpala flower.

Om a-sne mahāteja, sarvakarma-pasādhuka, kāruṇya-kṛta-sattva-artha,
asmin-sannihito bhava. This is the mantra for drawing in by fire.

Ma-ma, holder of varied jewels,
goddess of Hevajra's wrathful offering —
you are now brought under command.

Mighty one, I inquire of the maṇḍala:

svārtha-caiva-parārtha-ca sādhitam gaccha havya-bhuk, āgamiṣyasi
yathā-kāle sarva-siddhiṃ kuru-ṣva me. This is the mantra of the fire's delight.

Om jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Khaṃ raṃ — the mantra of the water of welcome. Om
niriti hūṃ khaṃḥ — the mantra of foot-washing. Om dhvaṃ dhvaṃ — the
mantra of the food offering.

Here ends the first chapter, the chapter on perfect consecration, being the
second tantra drawn from the vows of the web of ḍākinīs of Hevajra.

Vajra-Essence then made this supplication:

With respect to all phenomena, which are like space,
just as reflections appear in the ocean,
how do sentient beings come to be accomplished
through the form of one's chosen deity?

The Blessed One then declared:

One who is endowed with the yoga of selflessness,
or one who strives earnestly in the glorious Heruka —
even for an instant, with a mind turned to another,
one who desires attainment cannot remain.

At the time when one first cultivates practice,
the praised state of mind in whatever location —
one should carefully examine whichever place
is good and conducive to achieving single-pointed meditative equipoise.

At midnight, in one's own home,
with the mind of accomplishing one's own nature,
one skilled in wisdom who meditates on the yoginī,
or who meditates on the glorious Heruka's form —
the washing and eating of the feet,
drinking and scattering, eating of tooth-cleanser,
anointing the hands with sandalwood,
covering the legs with a lower garment,
arising, speaking, and walking,
sitting, being wrathful, and being excited,
reverencing the Blessed Lady,

and by means of wisdom and observance —
one meditates upon the yoginī throughout.
Even for an instant with another's manner,
a harmful mind is not appropriate;

One who desires attainment, for the sake of attainment,
the wise one strives — it does not remain still.

Meditative concentration that destroys the afflictions:
this vajra-essence (vajrasattva) I have taught.

With loving devotion, for the sake of attainment,
one realizes fully within half a month.

Having utterly abandoned all conceptual intention,
by meditating with the mind on the deity's form,
without a single day's interruption,
meditate and examine fully.

For accomplishing the benefit of self and others,
in saṃsāra there is no other skillful means.

By practicing together with the vidyā consort,
one immediately brings it to direct experience.

Fear, madness, and likewise suffering,
sorrow, torment, and harm,
and the great attachment, aversion, and delusion —
the practitioner is not afflicted by these.

Having thus understood with certainty
the arising of the fruits of benefit and harm,
in whatever manner, even for an instant,
the yoginīs are always to be invoked.

One who commits the five acts of immediate retribution,
and one who delights in killing living beings,
and also one of inferior birth,
one who acts from confusion and wrongfulness,
one of ugly form and lacking limbs —
even these, by being included in mind, can attain accomplishment.

Habituating oneself to the ten virtues,
reverencing the guru, taming the sense faculties,
turning away entirely from pride and anger —

by these one shall surely attain accomplishment before long.
Through yoga practiced constantly,
by meditative equipoise one attains accomplishment.
Practice in secret for one month.
Until the mudrā is found,
a mantrin who has received permission
should be shown the path by the yoginī.

Bearing the great mudrā,
for the sake of sentient beings the vajra-bearer
must find a consort who is wide-eyed,
adorned with form and youth,
endowed with camphor (karpūra) and saffron (sīhla),
purified through the awakening mind (bodhicitta).
Beginning with the ten virtues,
teach her the Dharma thoroughly.
Being of one mind with the mind of the deity's form
and one with the mind of sacred commitment,
within one month she becomes one who is fortunate —
of this there is no doubt.

Whatever woman has attained the highest,
having truly abandoned all conceptual thought —
or else by my own power,
from gods, demigods, and humans,
or from yakṣas, or from semi-humans,
one draws the mudrā near and examines fully.
Take that one and put the conduct into practice.
For the sake of directly manifesting one's own nature,
what has been described as having a fearsome form
was not taught for the sake of enjoyment.
Is the mind stable or is it unsettled?
Examine one's own mind individually.

Vajraessence asks:

How does one endowed with the yoga of no-self
speak of mudrā-ness itself?

By mudrā upon mudrā, by mudrā-ness itself,
how does the accomplishment of the mudrā arise?

The Blessed One (the Buddha) declared:
Abandoning the form of woman,
let it become the form of the Blessed One.
The breasts, when abandoned, become shoulders.
In the kakkolā plant reside the center;
the two cheeks become like bells;
the nipple becomes one who possesses a navel.
The remainder is the very great self —
the form of the great hero Heruka.
Being born of union with Heruka,
without effort one becomes a hero.
A yogin capable of clear manifestation
thus attains the accomplishment of the mudrā.
Even through arising and dissolution,
skillful means and wisdom are not harmed.
Since skillful means is the nature of arising,
dissolution through wisdom brings saṃsāra to its end.
Therefore there is no ultimate dissolution;
in suchness itself there is no attachment.
Some are destroyed through dissolution,
but without something substantial to dissolve, there is no exhaustion.

Through the yoga of the generation stage,
one who holds the observances meditates on conceptual elaboration.
Having made conceptual elaboration like a dream,
that very elaboration is made free of elaboration.
Just as a magical illusion, just as a dream,
just as the existence of the intermediate state —
through the application of constant habituation,
the maṇḍala itself is likewise to be understood.

The great empowerment (mahāmudrā-abhiṣeka),
the great bliss known through wisdom —
this is its blessing.
The maṇḍala arises from nowhere else.

Black bliss, yellow bliss,
red bliss, white bliss,
green bliss, blue bliss —

all bliss, moving and unmoving —
bliss of wisdom, bliss of skillful means,
and likewise the bliss born throughout all —
bliss of what exists and bliss of what does not —
this is proclaimed as the bliss of Vajrasattva.

Then Vajrahṛdaya (Vajra-Heart) made this request: This yoga of the completion stage — its bliss is proclaimed as great bliss. If completion is meditation-free, what is there to seek through generation?

The Blessed One declared: How wondrous, O great bodhisattva! Through the force of faith, one truly experiences it. The bliss that arises from the non-materiality of the body cannot be put into words. In the manner of the pervaded and the pervader, bliss itself pervades all beings. Just as fragrance abides within a flower yet cannot be perceived as a material thing separate from the flower, so too, since form and so forth are without substantial existence, bliss itself becomes without object of reference.

I am existence, I am the absence of things, I am a buddha because I have realized things as they are. Whoever is overcome by laziness, whoever is bewildered — those do not know me.

The bhaga (sacred source) of the vajra-queen, bearing the form and features of the syllable E — the jewel casket of all buddhas — ever abides in the state of bliss. I am the one who teaches, and the Dharma is also I; I am the assembly endowed with its own retinue, and I am the one who listens. I am the Teacher who appears to the world and the aim to be accomplished. I am the world, and I am what transcends the world. I am the nature of co-emergent joy. Supreme, free of the extreme of joy, like a lamp in the darkness — so too, through the faith of the son, the bhaga of the queen is great bliss.

The Teacher endowed with the thirty-two major marks, adorned above all with the eighty minor marks, abides in the form known as the vital essence (bindu). Without that there is no bliss; without bliss, that too is absent. Since it lacks power, it depends on other conditions. Bliss arises from the yoga of the deity. Therefore the buddha is not a material thing, nor is its true nature simply the manner of non-materiality. Having a form with faces and hands, it is without form by reason of supreme bliss. Therefore all beings are declared to be co-emergent by nature, co-emergent by intrinsic nature. Through a mind whose aspects are utterly pure, its intrinsic nature is nirvāṇa itself. Through

the form of the deity's aspect — abiding in face, hands, and color — it abides by form alone, and yet it does so through the force of ordinary habitual tendencies.

That very thing by which any piece of poison kills all beings — one who truly knows the nature of that poison uses poison itself to expel poison. Just as one who has been seized by a wind-disorder is given a mixture of dark-seed legumes as food, and by means of a carefully examined antidote, wind is used to press upon wind — so from conceptual thought comes conceptual thought, and from existence itself come existences. Just as water that has entered the ear is drawn out by other water, so likewise conceptuality about things is to be purified by means of definitive determination. Just as one burned by a spark is further scorched by fire itself, so one burned by the fire of attachment is to be scorched by the fire of attachment itself.

Whatever actions of beings lead them into bondage, however they bind — if one is equipped with skillful means, through those very means one is liberated from the bondage of existence. What binds the world through attachment is released through attachment itself. This reversed meditation is not known to buddhas among the non-Buddhists.

From the intrinsic nature of the five elements, five arise from the universal source. From that single great joy, through distinction they proceed to become five. When kakkola is applied to the bola, through the habitual tendency of the tangible quality of hardness — since hardness belongs to the class of delusion-phenomena — delusion is proclaimed as Vairocana. Since the awakening mind is of the nature of wetness, wetness is declared the water element. Water, because of its unmoving form, leads to aversion; unmoving is Akṣobhya. From their union set in motion by the two, heat arises continually. Attachment in boundless measure is the vajra, and attachment arises from heat. What is contemplated in the kakkola is of the nature of wind; envy is Amoghasiddhi, and Amoghasiddhi arises from wind. Bliss and attachment become blood. Joy has the defining characteristic of space.

Space becomes the vajra through envy, and envy arises from space. Mind itself is a single great reality, yet it is made manifest through the form of the five. From those very five families, many thousands arise. Therefore all of these are of one intrinsic nature — supreme great bliss, utterly unchanging. Through the distinctions of the five minds — attachment and the rest — it comes to move as five. From families equaling the sands of the Ganges in

multitude, a gathering of Tathāgatas belongs to a single family. Within the families belonging to that gathering, there are the many families, and within those families, hundreds of aspects of family. And within those, the great families numbering in the hundreds of thousands — in families of tens of millions, the number becomes limitless. Among those, the countless families within each family arise from the family of supreme joy.

This concludes the second chapter, entitled "Settling the Siddhi from the Vow of the Net of Ḍākinīs of Hevajra."

Then the Blessed One Vajrasattva declared to the vajra yoginīs the method called "The Root of All Tantras." In verse:

Vow and empowerment,
likewise the language of intention,
joy and the division of moments,
and further, what is eaten and the like —

Then he declared concerning the vow:

The vow of all buddhas
abides in the manner of Evam.
The great bliss of the nature of Evam
is to be known rightly through empowerment.

Then the yoginīs addressed the Blessed One Vajrasattva with these words:

Blessed Teacher, lord above all beings,
the very vow of the ḍākinīs —
what is meant by its being of the nature of Evam?
Pray explain it in proper sequence.

The Blessed One declared:

The beautiful form of E,
adorned in its center by Vam,
the abode of all bliss,
the jeweled basket of the buddhas —
through the division of moments it becomes differentiated,
and joy arises from that.
One who knows the moment and knows the bliss
abides supremely in the nature of Evam.

Variety, ripening,
freedom from ripening, and likewise freedom from defining characteristics —
the four moments are fully known.
Thus shall the yogin come to know.

Embrace, and causing to flow, and so forth —
variety is taught in its various aspects.
Reversing karmic ripening,
feeding on the wisdom of bliss —
the awareness that "I have fed on bliss"
is declared to be freedom from ripening.
Beyond the three that are free from defining characteristics,
attachment and freedom from attachment are both abandoned.

Variety has the joy of the first.
Ripening has the joy of supreme delight.
Freedom from ripening has the joy free from joy.
Freedom from characteristics has the joy of innate co-emergence.

The master, the secret, and wisdom,
and the four blisses likewise correspond in the same way.
By the number of four empowerments,
they are called joy and the rest, in sequence.

Laughter, purity, the master himself,
and the view, the secret — so likewise.
From the clasped hand comes wisdom,
and the mutual embrace is the same.

For the accomplishment of sentient beings,
empowerment is taught in four aspects.
By scattering and pouring —
therefore it is called empowerment.

To one who has reached the wisdom of sixteen,
one embraces rightly with one's hands.
Through the union of vajra and bell,
the empowerment of master is proclaimed.

One beautifully formed, with wide eyes,
adorned with fair form and the bloom of youth —
with thumb and ring finger

one lets it fall into the student's mouth.

In that very moment, the taste of equality
is to be made the domain of the student's experience.
The teacher worships wisdom supremely,
and having made it blissful, one entrusts it.

The teacher has spoken: O great bodhisattva,
take the mudrā endowed with bliss.
Knowing that the student has grown great,
free from envy and anger,
the teacher grants him permission.
With full conviction, hold the vajra.

Now the activities of the student
who has requested the empowerment will be taught.
Upon seeing the guru bearing the mudrā,
one performs praise and offering in the proper way.

O Blessed One, great Peace, hear this!
The one who upholds the single vajra-yoga,
the practitioner of the unbreakable mudrā,
born from vajra-yoga —
just as you yourself are great in sovereignty,
O sovereign lord, please act toward me in the same way.
Sunk in the swamp-like mass of illness that is saṃsāra,
helpless and shelterless, protect me.

With delicious food and drink,
with the supreme wine of the vine,
with incense, with offerings to the gods, with garlands,
with bells, victory banners, and ointments —
with these offerings
the student worships the vajra-holder.
Perfectly attaining supreme joy,
in the instant of relinquishing all multiplicity,
the Teacher has spoken: O great bodhisattva,
take hold of great bliss completely.
Until awakening is reached,
hold the vajra for the sake of sentient beings.

Upon seeing that the student is endowed with compassion,
the Vajra-holder spoke these words:

This is great primordial wisdom itself,
dwelling fully within every body.

Its mode is non-dual and free from duality —
the essential core of what exists and what does not exist.
Pervading and abiding in all that is still and all that moves,
it is held to be of the nature of illusion in form.

Through the method of the maṇḍala-wheel
one shall always proceed with certainty.

Then Vajragarbha begged the pardon of all the yoginīs and addressed the
Blessed One with these words:

By what is the maṇḍala-wheel to be named?
In the city where all buddhas are the sovereign,
I, the Blessed One's servant, have become confused —
please explain it in its proper order.

The Blessed One declared:

The center is to be called the essence.
The awakening mind, which is great bliss,
is the very maṇḍala in that it receives;
and the assembly is likewise spoken of as the maṇḍala.
The wheel is named the element of space,
which purifies the sense-object realm and so forth.
Through the union of the bo and ka syllables,
the bliss thereof shall come to be known.

Vajragarbha asked:

By what is the vow to be called a vow,
and by what shall the sacred pledge be upheld?

The Blessed One declared:

That you have taken life,
that you have also spoken false words,
that you have taken what was not given,
and that you have resorted to another's woman —
the taking of a single mind's life is precisely this,
for life itself is declared to be mind.
Liberating the world is proclaimed

to be the word of falsehood.

The semen of a noble woman, taken without it being given,
and another's woman beautiful as your own —

Then all the yoginīs addressed the Blessed One with these words:

What then are those sense-objects? What are the faculties? What are the sense sources? What are the aggregates? What also are the elements? And what is the intrinsic nature of these?

The Blessed One declared:

The six sense-objects are:

form, sound, smell likewise,
taste, and likewise tangible objects,
and the very nature of the element of phenomena —
these are said to be the six sense-objects.

The faculties are six:

eye and ear, nose,
tongue, body, and likewise mind.

These six faculties

are possessed of the vajra of delusion and so forth.

Through sense-object and sense-faculty together
the two nurturing sense sources arise.

The five aggregates are form and so forth,
and at their end, consciousness — great compassion.

Faculty and sense-object themselves,
and the consciousness of the faculty itself:
for the yoginīs to understand,
the elements are taught as eighteen.

The intrinsic nature is primordially unborn,
neither false nor true, just so.

All things are like the moon in water —
let the yoginī know this through desire.

It is like this: from a fire-drill and a fire-board and the exertion of a person's hands, fire suddenly arises. This fire does not abide in the fire-drill, nor does it abide in the fire-board, nor is it in the person's hands. If one searches for it in every respect, it does not exist in any single one of those places — and thus

that fire is neither true nor false. In just this way let the yoginī contemplate all phenomena in mind.

Then the yoginī Nairātmyā and all the other vajra-ḍākinīs took up the five nectars and the substances of sacred commitment and made offering to the Blessed One Vajrasattva. With the union of all together they aroused his delight. And they drank the taste of the five nectars.

Then the Blessed One, pleased, revealed his own blessing in verse:

Hail, hail, O vajra-ḍākinīs!
That very suchness which all buddhas revere,
which I have kept as secret —
through the blessing of vajra-offering
I shall now explain it. Hearken with desire.
May all the goddesses rejoice.

Filled with joy, they placed their right knees on the ground, joined their palms toward the Blessed One, bowed, and listened to the words of the Blessed One.

The Blessed One declared:

Food and drink — take whatever is found.
Do not abandon what is traversable or untraversable.
Do not perform ablutions or acts of purification.
Thoroughly abandon the customs of the village.
Though intelligent, do not recite mantra aloud.
Do not fix the mind on meditative concentration as an object.
Do not abandon sleep.
Do not suppress the sense faculties.
Eat all impure things.
Engage equally with all five colors.
With a mind utterly free of doubt,
bring delight to all women.
Do not treat a friend as beloved,
and likewise do not feel aversion toward an enemy.
Do not bow to these gods —
those of stone, wood, and clay.
Servant-women, outcastes, hide-tanners,
washerwomen and the like, those of the untouchable class,
brahmins, kṣatriyas, minor lords, and commoners —
touch them as you would touch your own body.

The five nectars, molasses-beer,
poison, and that which is born from a mother giving birth,
sour things, sweet things, and roasted grain and so forth,
snow, salt, hot things,
malodorous things, fragrant things, saliva and mucus —
mix these with awakening mind and eat them fully.
With a mind of non-dual gnosis,
there is not even a little that may not be eaten.
Having found a self-arisen flower,
place it in a lotus vessel,
and mixed with spittle and with mucus,
let the one of vows drink it.
Adorn oneself likewise with a lower garment of various colors
and with ash from a cremation ground.
Having found a wreath of flowers at the charnel ground,
tie it properly around the head.

Then Vajrahṛdaya asked: "Those of the realm of appearances are, the Blessed One declared before, entirely pure. Then why has the Blessed One not made the number of the six sense faculties definitively pure?"

The Blessed One declared:

At the eye, the Vajra Lady of Delusion.
At the ear, the Vajra Lady of Aversion.
At the nose, it is said, the Lady of Miserliness.
At the mouth, the Vajra Lady of Desire.
At the body, the Vajra Lady of Envy.
At the mind, the Yoginī of No-Self.
It is for the purification of the sense faculties
that this great bodhisattva armor is worn.

Vajrahṛdaya asked: "What is the intentional language called? The Blessed One has spoken of it definitively. The great sacred commitments of the yoginī, unknown to hearers and the like — through laughter and through view, through embrace and likewise through the pairs, and through the four kinds of tantra — this intentional language has not been proclaimed. May the Blessed One kindly declare it definitively."

"The great intentional language and the extensive coded language of sacred commitment — Vajrahṛdaya, I shall explain it. Listen with one-pointed mind.

Wine is expressed as madana. A gathering is expressed as mālaya-ja. A traveler is expressed as kheṭara-śrāpa. A bone ornament is expressed as nirāṃśu. Coming is expressed as phraṃkhaṇaru. A lute is expressed as kṛpīṭa. One without fortune is expressed as dhura. One with fortune is expressed as kālinjiraṃ. What is not to be touched is expressed as diṇaḍima. A skull cup is expressed as padmabhajanaṃ. Food is called tṛptika. Vegetables are expressed as mālahandhanaṃ. Feces are expressed as catuḥsamaṃ. Urine is expressed as kastūri. What is self-arisen is to be understood as sigra. Semen is expressed as karūra. Great flesh is expressed as śaliraṃ. The union of the two organs is expressed as kunturu. The vajra is expressed as bola. The lotus is called kakkola. Divided by the distinction of colors, the families are taught as five in number."

This is the secret language. The five mudrās in brief: the sleeping woman belongs to the vajra family; the dancing woman likewise to the lotus family; the self-arisen woman to the jewel family; the twice-born to the Tathāgata family; and the dyed woman belongs to the karma family. These mudrās bestow attainments. These become the semen-vajra. One who possesses conduct drinks them after making offering. O Vajrahṛdaya, great bodhisattva, the secret language is most wondrous. Whatever I have taught you — receive all of it with reverence.

O Vajra, whosoever receives empowerment here yet does not speak in the secret language — their samaya will be broken; of this there is no doubt. Even if harmed by violence, by theft, by spirits, by epidemic, or by poison, if one does not speak the secret language of the buddhas, one will still perish. One who has found one's own samaya and family — if one does not speak these words, the yoginī born from one of the four abodes will at that time become wrathful.

Hail, O Vajra! This is the third chapter of the Ḍākinī-vajra-net Tantra, called "The Occasion for All Tantras and the Secret Language."

Then all the vajra ḍākinīs beginning with Vajrahṛdaya fell into doubt and became of two minds. They addressed the Blessed One Vajrasattva thus:

Blessed One, please resolve our doubt. From the chapter on conduct it was taught that song and dance bestow attainments — about this we are uncertain. What is song, and what is dance? From the chapter on the deities,

the mudrās of aversion and so forth were taught — about these we are uncertain. Whose mudrā is a mudrā, and what mudrā is it? From the collection of mantras it was taught that selflessness and the like are the very seeds — about this we have become confused. Whose seed is a seed, and what seed is it? From the chapter on families, the root in the nature of the sixteen and two was taught — Blessed One, we have become confused; please explain these clearly.

The Blessed One then declared: Kolli iriṭṭhi abolā, mummuni re kakkholā, ghaṇakiṃpiṭa ho badzai, kuruni ki a iṇarolā, tahiṃ bala khadzai, gaḍheṃ ma aṇāpidza ai, hale kāliṇdzara paṇi ai, dunduru pādzi ai, tza um katschursihilā kappura lā i a i, māla i indhana sālntza tahiṃ bharukha i a e, pheṃ khaṇakheṭa karante śuddhā śuddhā namuni ai, niraṃ śu aṃge tza ḍāvita hidzisarā bapaṇi ai, malaya dze kunduru bāṭa i, ḍiṇḍima tahiṃ badzai ai.

The yogin who does not lose mindfulness dances in the form of Heruka. With a mind unaccustomed to detachment, one meditates with the mind of desire. Together with vajra, Dharma, buddha, and yoginī — with these as mother — one should properly take up the song and perform the dance. By this very means the gathering is guarded, and likewise oneself is guarded. By this one brings the world under one's power. By this one performs the recitation of mantras.

Wherever one reverently sings, wherever one respectfully dances — the lord of the assembly, having performed it first, should then indicate a scent. The first is the scent of garlic; then the scent of a vulture; camphor and malaya fragrance; the sounds of geese and bees — these are to be heard at the end of the song. The lowing of cattle too is to be indicated in the outer grove, and is the characteristic of the blessing of the boat. The mudrā's sign and mark — by this the family is to be indicated.

In a practice of meditation that seeks the family, there is no attainment and no accomplishment apart from it. The mudrā of aversion is the selflessness woman; the mudrā of delusion is the vajra woman.

The mudrā of miserliness is the white woman herself. The mudrā of attachment is to be sealed with the water woman. The mudrā of envy is the ḍākinī. The mudrā of aversion is Pukkasī. The mudrā of delusion is the forest-dwelling woman. The mudrā of miserliness is the outcaste woman. The mudrā of desire is the servant woman herself.

Again, from the white woman and aversion: the mudrā of delusion is the thief woman. The mudrā of miserliness is the zombie woman. The mudrā of desire is Ghasmarī. The mudrā of delusion is the earth-faring woman. The mudrā of desire is the sky-faring woman. Through desire, the mudrā is to be known.

The first vowel is the selflessness woman. The second vowel is the vajra woman. The third vowel is the white woman herself. The fourth is the water yoginī. The fifth is the vajra dākinī. The sixth is spoken as Pukkasī. The seventh is the forest-dwelling woman. The eighth is spoken as the one with a dark mark. The ninth again is the servant woman. And again, ten and five together are the white woman herself. The eleventh is spoken as the thief woman. The twelfth is spoken as the zombie woman. The thirteenth is Ghasmarī. The fourteenth is the earth-faring woman. The fifteenth is the sky-faring woman. These are the very seeds of the yoginīs.

From the chapter on family, those roots are spoken of as having the nature of twice sixteen. Each pair of channels is a yoginī, and each one is spoken of in three aspects: the extended, the contracted, and the trembling. These are called the selflessness yoginī. Because of the indivisibility of the sixteen, one strives to abandon the remainder in everything. Why is this? Because the action of the meaning is not performed. The moon, whose nature is the fraction of fifteen, becomes the awakening mind. Great bliss is the form of the vowel series; the yoginīs are its fractions.

Vajragarbha asked: "All that arises from the yoginīs is of the nature of co-emergent bliss itself. The supreme drink of undiminished sky-space — why is camphor necessarily to be abandoned?"

The Blessed One declared: "It is exactly as has been said." Vajragarbha asked: "By what method is the awakening mind to be aroused?" The Blessed One declared:

By the method of the wheel of the maṇḍala, and also by the gradual sequence of self-consecration, the awakening mind — endowed with form as both conventional and ultimate — is fully aroused. The conventional is like the present moment; the ultimate has the form of bliss. The woman who is blissful like the kokkola berry, whose intrinsic nature is the form of evaṃ — for the sake of protecting bliss, she is proclaimed to be "the blissful one."

This very place is the abode of the buddhas, bodhisattvas, and vajra-holders; this very place is called saṃsāra, and this very place is nirvāṇa itself. Having abandoned saṃsāra, nirvāṇa will not be realized elsewhere. Saṃsāra is form

and sound and so forth; saṃsāra is feeling and so forth; saṃsāra is the very nature of the sense faculties; saṃsāra is aversion and so forth. These phenomena are nirvāṇa. Because of bewilderment, they take on the form of saṃsāra; without bewilderment, through the purity of saṃsāra, saṃsāra becomes nirvāṇa. The awakening mind is nirvāṇa: it is the mode of both conventional and ultimate truth.

She is exceedingly fine-featured, wide-eyed, adorned with beauty of form and the bloom of youth, with clear complexion and a leisurely manner, of noble family — the place of origin of Sinhalese camphor. She herself confers the empowerment of the kye-vajra. With beautiful hair, she is fond of the practitioner. There, too, one should drink wine, and then oneself also should drink. In order to fully accomplish the purpose of the intrinsic nature, one should afterwards engage in mudrā union. Having entered the kokkola into the bo, one continually performs the vow of the disciplined practitioner. From that union, the camphor that has arisen — the wise one does not reject it; yet neither is it to be taken in the hand, and it is not the nature of fish or conch. Because of resolute mind and strength, it is to be taken by the undying tongue.

Camphor itself is the selflessness woman; bliss is of the mode of selflessness. The great seal of that bliss abides in the center of the navel maṇḍala. It is the nature of the primary vowel syllable, and is examined by the buddhas as mind. From the yoga of the completion stage —

That very suchness is the Blessed Wisdom Woman. She is neither long nor short, neither four-cornered nor round. She transcends smell, taste, and touch. She is the one who produces innate joy. The yogin who is born from her consumes the very bliss of that union. Together with her, the great seal becomes the spiritual attainment that bestows bliss.

Form, sound, and likewise smell, taste, and likewise tangible objects — even the intrinsic nature of the dharmadhātu — all are to be examined by wisdom itself. That very form born of innate co-emergence is the yoginī of great bliss and goodness. That very one possesses the nature of the maṇḍala wheel and the five wisdoms. She is the form of mirror-like wisdom, possessed of the substance of the wisdom of equality. She is the perfectly arisen discriminating wisdom. That very activity is fervent and resolute. She is the utterly pure one of the dharmadhātu. That very maṇḍala lord is I myself. That very one is the no-self yoginī, possessing the intrinsic nature of the dharmadhātu.

Vajragarbha then asked: Regarding the path of meditating on the wheel, how the deities arise, and all of it — since the Blessed One has spoken — I request that the vow too be explained to me.

The Blessed One declared: In the center of the yoginī's body dwells the abode of the vow in the form of the syllable A. Just as it is outwardly, so it is inwardly: the vow itself is fully unfolded. The great bliss of the bo is the great seal. The vajra sense-base is the great skillful means. By means of this secret meditative absorption, there is no dual-by-dual teaching of the external. Within the body, the forms of the three bodies as wheels are to be described.

The full knowing of the three bodies is described as the wheel of great bliss. The dharmakāya, the saṃbhogakāya, and the nirmāṇakāya — and likewise great bliss itself — abide in their three aspects at the navel, heart, throat, and crown.

With respect to the birth that is to be described for sentient beings — all without exception — because the nirmāṇakāya abides as stable emanation, it is therefore the very emanation body itself. The body by which one generates and emanates is called "possessing emanation." The mind is the intrinsic nature of phenomena, and it becomes the dharmakāya at the heart. What is possessed of the form of the six tastes — the food one surely partakes of — is spoken of as the saṃbhogakāya. At the throat abides the wheel of enjoyment; at the crown abides the great bliss.

The syllables E and VAM, being concordant causes, produce the saṃbhogakāya from the wheel of Dharma that is karmic maturation. The wheel of bliss, immaculate, with its concordant causes gathering and elaborating — the fruit is spoken of as fourfold.

Stirred by the winds of karma, the Blessed Wisdom engages in karmic action. However one has acted, accordingly one continues to engage. This is proclaimed as "the concordant cause." Because the fruit is great while the action is small, karmic maturation is reversed from that cause. Because yogins are therefore immaculate, the generating is the activity of the hero. Because the nirmāṇakāya abides in stable emanation, stability abides in the wheel of emanation. Because the arising of the speaking of Dharma occurs, all things abide in the wheel of Dharma. Because all things are venerated at the throat, veneration abides in the wheel of enjoyment. Because the great bliss abides at the crown, in the wheel of bliss there is the great Saṅgha.

The community — so called — is described as the body. The belly is to be described as the abiding place. The birthplace becomes free from attachment. The umbilical membrane is the Dharma-robe. Likewise, the mother is the ācārya. The palms joined at the crown are the obeisance. The activity of migrating beings is the place of discipline. The recitation of mantras is A and HŪṂ. The form of the wheel at the birthplace is A; the aspect of the expanse of great bliss is HŪṂ. Naked, with hair and beard shaved — the mantra-reciting male is the monk himself. By these conditions, sentient beings, without doubt, are caused to become buddhas. They are those in the ten full months.

They are the lords of the ten grounds (bhūmis) of sentient beings.

Then, upon all the yoginīs — Nairātmyā and the other goddesses, namely Locanā, Māmakī, Pāṇḍaravāsini, Tārā, Bhṛkuṭī, Cundā, Parṇaśavarī, Uttaramukhā, and all the rest, as numberless as the finest dust particles of Mount Meru — upon hearing these words, every one of those yoginīs was supremely astonished, fell into a swoon, became frightened, collapsed to the ground, and began to tremble.

Then the Vajra-holder, gazing upon all those goddesses, praised them rightly in order to revive them:

You goddesses, vessels who eat the gifts
of earth and water, wind and fire —
that which no one whatsoever knows,
that very reality I, with delight, proclaim: hear it!

Upon hearing this, like the speech of the Blessed One in a dream, all of them recovered their vitality.

The Blessed One then declared:

Sentient beings are buddhas themselves,
yet they are veiled by adventitious stain.
When that is cleared away, buddha they are.

A goddess asked: Blessed One, it is just so — it is neither true nor false.

The Blessed One declared:

Those worldly ones who do not know
will swoon as if they have swallowed a virulent poison.
Having abandoned confusion, through the mind of suchness,
one cuts suchness thoroughly by that very suchness.

Likewise, knowing the means of pacification
and resting in the Hevajra —
not grasping at ignorance and the rest,
not bound by delusion and the rest —
from one's own self-recognition by oneself,
not a single one exists, whether buddha
or sentient being, apart from that.

Hell-beings, hungry ghosts, animals,
gods, asuras, and humans,
worms of excrement and the like,
and even gods and asuras —
because they do not know whatever bliss there is,
they remain always of a naturally blissful nature.
In no world-realm whatsoever
will a buddha be found elsewhere.
Mind itself is perfect buddhahood;
a buddha cannot be shown as something other.

Caṇḍālas (outcastes), basket-weavers, and the like,
those who contemplate the act of killing —
if they know these as Hevajra,
accomplishment will come: of this there is no doubt.

Those obscured by childish ignorance,
not knowing the migrations of this life,
at the end of existence in the six migrations,
whoever wanders in confusion through saṃsāra —
the great compassion of Vajragarbha,
and through finding the means of Hevajra,
whoever thoroughly purifies the sense-objects:
that one will attain the unsurpassed.

Vajragarbha asked: Earth has been explained as the Pukkaṣī,
and since delusion is by nature solid,
the body has been said to be Vairocana himself —
how then is Akṣobhya's mudrā to be understood?

The Blessed One declared:
Abandoning mind, through the body alone,

beauty is not found to be otherwise.
Therefore, upon Vairocana's mind,
seal the body with the mudrā of the awakened mind.

Vajragarbha asked: The water element has been explained as the Śavarī of the wilderness,
and Akṣobhya is of the nature of semen.
With the chief Akṣobhya mudrā,
would it not be fitting to seal the wilderness-dweller?

The Blessed One declared:
Abandoning the body, through mind alone,
dwelling is not seen to be otherwise.
Therefore mind becomes delusion,
and upon the awakened mind, seal the mudrā of delusion.

Vajragarbha asked: Fire has been explained as the Caṇḍālī woman,
and the Caṇḍālī woman is sealed with the mudrā of attachment.
If her mudrā is indeed distinct from others,
how then is the jewel mudrā to be understood?

The Blessed One declared:
Since attachment has been explained as blood,
and blood is of the nature of the jewel source,
and warmth is the intrinsic nature of blood —
seal attachment and miserliness with the jewel mudrā.

Vajragarbha asked: Since the Ḍombī woman is wind itself,
and Amoghā is of the form of wind,
it would seem fitting to seal the Ḍombī woman,
the chief one, with the mudrā of Amogha.

The Blessed One declared:
Jealousy does not arise from anywhere
other than attachment —

Therefore, the one with skillful means should seal the singer woman with the mudrā of attachment. Since form is itself solid, the White One has been taught as Vairocana. Following the sequence already taught, seal her with the Lord of Mind's mudrā. By that same logic, the Caṇḍālī woman; likewise the Corpse-Raiser woman herself; and by her logic, Ghasmarī — the mudrā arises

Hail, O Vajra, O Vajrapāṇi! To the very deity abiding in meditative absorption, for the sake of sentient beings, the great tormā offering is made. Regarding this, Nairātmyā asked:

Om indra-jama-jala-ja-klā, bhūta-vahni-bā-u-rakṣa-caṇḍa-sujjha-māda-bapba-t
ala-pā-tāle-aṭṭha-sa-bba-svāhā. Idam balim
bhuñja-ji-gha-phulla-dhuppa-māmsa-bimgha.

If by this torma offering all spirits are propitiated, the yogins will prosper well. For them there will be stainless bliss, and the goddesses and the beings who have abundantly arrived will rejoice. If one continuously makes the torma offering for the sake of the assembly of spirits, it will also bring about power, fierce action, the destruction of enemy forces, expulsion, slaying, summoning, pacification, and increase.

The Blessed One declared: In the center of the wheel of the three secrets — divided into body, speech, and mind — abiding perfectly in the center of the wheel that dwells above, below, and in the middle: the earth-going woman, bearing the mudrā of the body, is the upper-faced Vajra Woman; the sky-going woman, bearing the mudrā of attachment, is the lower-faced Vajra Woman of speech; the Vajra Woman of mind is Nairātmyā. Mind itself is of the nature of selflessness, and mind abides in the central place — therefore Nairātmyā arises at the center.

From the fuller exposition, the family is spoken of in six aspects. Listen, O yoginī, to what has been taught as the triple aspect and as the fivefold aspect. Akṣobhya, Vairocana, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha, Amoghasiddhi, and Vajrasattva. Aversion, delusion, and miserliness; attachment, jealousy, and bliss — these are to be cultivated in sequence. Setting aside Vajrasattva, the

family is then fivefold externally, becoming threefold through attachment, aversion, and delusion. Akṣobhya, who is aversion in form, is one single family — the Lord of Mind. This blessing of the vajra of aversion is spoken of as six families and five.

This concludes the fourth chapter, entitled The Meaning of the Condensed Mudrās of All the Tantras, from the Hevajra Tantra.

Then the king Vajradhara, the chief Hevajra, bestowing all things, correctly declared the maṇḍalas of his own nature in all aspects. By his own nature in all aspects he truly abides in the blissful realm. From the seed of the vajra of mind he generates his own maṇḍala: with sixteen hands, eight faces, four feet, a terrifying one, a hero bearing a garland of skulls, embraced at the neck by Nairātmyā. To the deity holding the five mudrās, Nairātmyā herself asked:

You have described your wheel as completely surrounded by twenty-five — what then is your maṇḍala like? The chief one I have not previously sought to know.

Having taken delight in Nairātmyā —

Having granted the vajra skull-cup,
he fondled the goddess's breasts.

Perfectly revealing the maṇḍala —
the wheel as previously described:
adorned with garlands and half-garlands,
four boundary-lines, four gates,
perfectly ornamented with vajra cords,
and through the allure of great passion,

from the nature of innate joy,
beautiful-faced one, together with you —
there in the center I myself abide:
eight-faced, four-footed,
adorned with sixteen hands,
the very one who subdues the four māras,
terrifying beyond all terror,
wearing a garland of skulls as a necklace,
seated on the sun disc, with musical accompaniment,
dark of color, dreadful,
holding the variegated vajra (viśvavajra) at the crown,
from his own mouth blazing forth HŪM,

his body smeared with ash.

Joined in union with Nairātmyā,
entering into each successive bliss in pairs,
one who possesses bliss without waves of agitation,
bearing the nature of freedom from conceit —
the root face is great and black;
on the right, resembling the jasmine flower;
on the left, red and greatly terrifying;
the crown face is fierce and wrathful;
the eyes are great in number — twenty-four;
the remaining faces are dark as bees.

In the city, you and I, delighting,
sporting exceedingly in joy,
the white goddess is drawn forth from the direction of Indra
and perfectly abides at the eastern gate.

From the union of stirring and being stirred,
the outcast woman too is drawn forth —
drawn forth, she abides at the southern gate:
the outcast woman as the gate-protectress.

Through the union of kakkolā,
the zombie woman (vetālinī) is also drawn forth —
drawn forth, she abides at the western gate:
the demon-slayer (māravijayinī) fully stationed there.

From the absorption of great bliss,
Ghasmarī is also drawn forth —
drawn forth, she abides at the northern gate:
she of terrifying form stationed there.

From the union set in motion by the two,
Pukkasī is also drawn forth —
drawn forth, she abides at the corner of the lord of gods (Indra's direction):
she of fierce form stationed there.

Again, through the union of stirring,
the forest-dwelling woman (śabarinī) at the corner of fire,
the caṇḍālinī at the corner of the rākṣasas,

and the dombī at the corner of wind.

Then from the great vajra-passion,
it dissolved into the vidyā together with the bindu.
Through the offering of various songs,
then the goddesses urged him on:

"Venerable one, rouse your compassionate mind!
Pukkasī — protect me!
Abandoning the nature of mere emptiness,
be pleased to grant me the great bliss union.
Without you I am destroyed —
hey, vajra hero, arise!
Abandoning the nature of mere emptiness,
fulfill the forest-woman's fruit of accomplishment!"

"Chief of joy, welcoming the world as guest —
do you dwell in emptiness alone?
Without you I seek no direction:
the caṇḍālinī makes smoke as an offering to me.
I seek to touch your heart —
you who possess illusion's power, arise!
The dombī, recalling that we are equal,
do not let your stream of compassion be cut off!"

The elephant, horse, bull, mule,
human, śarabha, and cat —
from the eight skulls on the right side
the pair of drinkers and so on, know them in sequence.

Earth, water, wind, and fire,
moon and sun themselves,
the destroyer and the wealth-giver —
these are in the eight skulls on the left.

Seductive, heroic, and ugly,
laughing, fierce, and terrifying,
compassionate, wrathful, and peaceful —
endowed with the flavor of the nine dances.

With OM̐ and HŪM̐, the great vajra,
having arisen from the form of bindu,
the feet stamping upon the earth,
he caused gods and demigods (asuras) to tremble.

GĀM̐ CĀM̐ BĀM̐ GHĀM̐, ŚĀM̐ CĀM̐ LĀM̐ ḌĀM̐ —
from these, the seeds being drawn forth,
by the seeds of the lord himself,
OM̐ HŪM̐, blue, blazing, terrifying —
the Māmakī wheel in a delightful city,
dark of color, greatly terrifying,
Nairātmyā, the bestower of bliss.

This is how the chief deity is to be visualized:
to the right of the white goddess, a hooked knife (kartikā),
and likewise on the left, rohita;
to the right of the outcast woman (caṇḍālinī), a chopper (kartarī),
and in the left hand, a pig.

To the right of the zombie woman (vetālinī), a bone frog,
and in her left hand, a lotus vessel.

To the right of Ghasmarī, a magical apparition,
and in the left hand, the yogin's skull-bowl itself.

To the right of Pukkasī, a lion,
and in the left hand likewise, an enemy's hide.

To the right of the forest woman, a monk,
and in the left hand likewise, a cool-maker.

To the right of the outcaste woman, a wheel,
and in the left hand likewise, a skull.

To the right of the gypsy woman (ḍombī), a vajra itself,
and in the left hand likewise, a threatening gesture.

They stand in a posture of half-seated dance.

The white goddess and the rest — two hands are indicated.

Three eyes, and hair upswept.

Adorned in full with the five mudrās.

Gaurī becomes dark of color.

The thief woman resembles one who has been cut.

The zombie woman resembles one cooked in gold.

Ghasmarī resembles an old woman.

Pukkasī resembles the former sovereign.

The forest woman has the radiance of the moon's gem.

The fierce one is the sky-blue woman.

The gypsy woman is called the variegated one.

Brahmā, the Sovereign (Indra), the nearby Sovereign, the fierce one,

Yama, and the Lord of Wealth,

the truthless one, and Takṣaka's lineage —

upon the thrones of Gaurī and the rest,

having trodden upon them and embraced them tightly, causing them to cry out,

the Blessed One is reverently worshipped,

and Nairātmyā requests the mantra.

The mantra that subjugates all women,

and likewise that which subdues the vicious and the sinful,

and that which subdues the nāgas,

and that which overwhelms gods and demigods (asuras) —

that I shall now expound.

Listen, O goddess, bestower of bliss!

I have not taught this elsewhere,

even to buddhas and bodhisattvas.

By the mantra of this, whatever arises,

and whatever the vajra-being accomplishes —

O goddess, it is utterly terrifying,

and because it cannot be looked upon directly, I declare it to you.

Having erected a maṇḍala of swirling, blazing garlands,

in order to grant the empowerment of the vajra-essence,

the supreme bindu is drawn in,

clarified by ten thousand recitations,

and by the far-reaching and excellent sound,

through the yoga of the Kīla-vajra,

all consorts are to be summoned.

With a hundred thousand recitations, I, the master of yoga,

by the yoga of the Kīla-vajra,

with a mind free of doubt,

by this one, perform all actions.

It grants the first of the knowledge texts,
adorned with the half-moon and bindu.

Then: AṢṬĀNĀNĀYA, PIMGA ŪRDHVAKĒṢA BṚTAMANE, CATURBHĀŚATĪNITĀYA.

After that: ṢOḌAŚABHUJĀYA, KṚṢṆĀJĪMŪTAVAPUṢE KABALĀMĀLĀIKĀDHĀRIṆE,
ĀDHAMĀTAḤ, KRŪRACITTĀYA ARDHENADU DAMṢṬRIṆE.

OM MĀRAYA MĀRAYA, KARAYA KĀRAYA, GARJAYA GARJAYA, TARJAYA TARJAYA,
ŚOṢAYA ŚOṢAYA, SAPTA SĀGARĀNI, BANDHA BANDHANA GĀṢṬAKĀṢ GRḤṆA
GRḤṆA ŚATRŪṢ, HA HĀ HI HĪ HU HŪ HE HAṢ HO HAU HAṢ HAḤ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

Then, that goddess being pleased,
from the union of the churning and the churned,
through tight embrace and the act of causing to cry out,
she requests the pleasing maṇḍala.

Thereupon, the Teacher, of great gnosis,
having joined vajra and lotus in union,
dwelling in meditative equipoise with a mind of joy,
drew out the maṇḍala of his own nature.

With a single vestibule and four gates,
thoroughly stirred by light of many colors,
complete with four stairways,
adorned with a vajra-cord fence.
Complete with five lines,
then draw the eight vases.

With powder of the five precious substances,
or with grain and the like,
or with charnel-ground teeth and tusks,
or likewise with charnel-ground charcoal —
in the center draw a lotus,
eight-petalled, with anthers.
At the heart draw a skull born there.
Draw three white portions.

In the east, where sovereign power abides, draw śarabha.
At the fire-corner, draw a monk.
In the south, draw a wheel.
In the wind-direction, draw the lord of the family.

Likewise at the eastern gate, draw a hooked knife.
In the south, draw a ḍamaru drum.

In the west, draw a tortoise.

In the north, likewise, draw a snake.

By the division of the goddess's colors,
the eight emblems are widely renowned.

In the center, also draw a white skull
marked with the variegated vajra.

Then place the victory vase,
adorned with fine cloth at the tips of its branches,
its belly filled with the five precious substances,
and set it fully packed with rice plants.

Why speak at length of all this?
Just as it is, perform the maṇḍala ritual
condensed in that very way.

The eight vidyās (Skt. vidyā) of great bliss,
who have reached their twelfth and eighth years,
adorned with necklaces and anklets,
are to be introduced into the maṇḍala.

The mother, the sister,
the daughter, the younger sister,
likewise the wife of an uncle,
the mother's kinswomen and the aunt,
likewise the father's sister —
these are renowned as the eight consorts (vidyās).

By embracing them closely and causing the blissful flow,
the yogin is to honor these with offerings.

From that, one should drink the camphor.
With it, one should fumigate and purify the maṇḍala.
These the yogin should drink.
Attainment will be swiftly obtained.

In that, one should also drink beer,
eat meat and rice.
Having done so, removing one's garments,

one should properly anoint the bhaga.
With that, one should pound the bola.
One should dance and take up song.
Having mixed the bola with kakkolā,
one should play and sport in that.

Then, in the second watch of the night,
covering the disciple's eyes with cloth,
one should introduce the disciple there.
From outside, one reveals the maṇḍala fully.

At night, in a house with no other people,
the master and the rest, having opened it fully,
should confer the empowerment upon the disciple
exactly as the empowerment has been taught.

The good disciple should first know in advance
how the offering and praise are to be performed.
To reveal that very suchness to them:
it is supreme, free from joy, bounded at its extreme,
concealed in all tantras,
opened at the ultimate limit of limits.

Having perfectly joined it with the vajra-offering,
the goddess then asked of that:
"What is the instant of that god like?
Let the Great Lord please explain."

The Blessed One declared: "Therein there is no beginning, middle, or end.
There is no existence, and no nirvāṇa.
This is supreme great bliss itself,
without self, and without other as well.

In the two waves of enjoyment,
with the thumb and the other finger
of one's own right hand and the other hand,
the yogin presses.
From that, gnosis arises.

"What arises from that?" one might ask.
It is like the joy of youth,

like the dream of one who is mute.

The supreme extreme, free from joy, the middle —
empty and non-empty: Heruka (Skt. Heruka).

This is the fifth chapter of the Hevajra (Skt. Hevajra), called "The Clear Arising of Hevajra."

Embracing the goddess closely,
having placed her in the bowl-skull,
and firmly grasping her breast,
squeezing the man's nose,
pressing her lips with one's teeth,
scratching the armpit with a nail,
and having experienced the bliss of union,
the five mudrās are fully revealed.

The guru and master, the god of desire —
to him one bows, holding the wheel for this purpose.
For the sake of not heeding words of blame
addressed to the guru, the vajra-holder,
one wears earrings in the ears.
Recitation of mantra is the neck ornament.
Bracelets signify the abandonment of killing living beings.
Reliance on the mudrā (consort) is the belt.
With the seals of the five buddhas,
one always seals the body.

Then, having laughed aloud,
pressing her lips with one's teeth,
what is called the Hevajra
is the form of co-emergent (Skt. sahaja) being.

The goddess then asked: "By what ritual
and by what action
is the painted icon of Hevajra
to be made? Speak, O Great Bliss."

The Blessed One declared: "Here, the one who inquires must be bound by
samaya,
and the one who makes it likewise — one bound by samaya
is to paint the fearsome painted icon.

The colors of the five skulls of a man,
using a brush of hair from a corpse,
the guru paints the icon himself."

Whoever spins the thread, and whoever weaves the cloth — they too must assuredly be bound by samaya. The yogin, consecrated by samaya, on the fourteenth day of each lunar fortnight, in a secluded house, at midnight with a clear mind, having drunk a little beer, having visualized the syllable RAM upon the body and thus become naked, with filth and impurity, then consumes the samaya substance. One who is fair of face, endowed with compassion, blessed with form and the good fortune of youth, who is fond of flowers and of the practice — she places her own mudrā to the left. This is the sixth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, entitled "The Ritual of the Painted Icon."

Then the goddess asked him: "Having applied the bolla and kakkolā, having pressed the lips with the teeth — how is the manuscript to be made? Having joined the vajra and the lotus together, the deity, opened in delight — of this manuscript I wish your explanation. O goddess of great fortune, listen. Having made ink from a large bee, with a pen of human bone, the manuscript of twelve finger-breadths is to be written in Grantha script by one who is bound by samaya. If the manuscript and the painted icon should happen to be seen by one who is unworthy, there will be no spiritual attainment in this life, and in the world beyond there will be no domain of activity. Show them only occasionally to one who possesses true generosity and full giving. For the manuscript, on the road as a domain of movement, conceal it in the hair or the armpit. Having placed the liṅga excellently in the bhaga, and having suckled repeatedly, one who bears the vajra reveals the food of great bliss experienced in equanimity. The making of the ganacakra maṇḍala — listen, O goddess of wide eyes. Wherever one eats, every desired aim is accomplished and the attainment of the accomplished practitioner arises. In a charnel ground, in a mountain's bird-shelter, likewise in a city without people, or else in a solitary place or at the ocean's edge — this food is to be supremely consumed. As for what is to be considered a seat therein: nine forms in the shape of a corpse, or else a tiger skin, or charnel ground cloth — likewise. At the center, knowing the form of Hevajra to be present just as it was described before, in the cardinal and intermediate directions, then arrange the yoginīs. The samaya substance, mālatīndānam, is to be consumed upon the tiger skin. With effort, one who is a king and master of Śālu consumes that food there.

And having eaten and eaten there, one is to make offering to the mother goddesses. Sisters, daughters, daughters-in-law — and even if one has a mother-sister — if these are always offered the supreme offering, the ganacakra maṇḍala will be accomplished. A large skull of a man, filled to the brim with excellent beer — O greatly fortunate one, offer it to the guru. Having prostrated, drink of it yourself as well. That which has been received with the lotus hand is offered with that very hand. Bowing again and again — thus is it to be done by the practitioner. This is the seventh chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, entitled "The Chapter on Food."

Then the yoginī asked: "What is the Great Seal (mahāmudrā)? Please explain how, through form at the level of conventional appearance, bliss is bestowed." The Blessed One declared: "Neither very tall nor short, neither dark-complexioned nor white, resembling the form of a lotus petal. Her breath is fragrant, and her very dust becomes fragrant too, like the scent of the navel of a mountain deer. And over the lotus as well, a supreme and excellent fragrance. Instantly it arises like a lotus. Her camphor and Sinhala qualities — a skilled one identifies through the fine fragrance. It becomes like the scent of the blue lotus, similar to black aguru. Slow and unmoving, speaking pleasingly, a woman who is beautiful of mind. Fine hair, three furrows in the center of the brow — most people call her one who bears the lotus. She who has the form of the co-emergent — having found her, attainment arises." Then the yoginī Nairātmyā (the selfless one) beseeched: "Blessed One, how is an aspiration to be made?" The Blessed One declared: "Born into the lineage and bound by samaya — teach Hevajra without madness."

Devoted to the guru, possessed of compassion —
may it be so, birth after birth.
Hands turning vajra and bell,
reading the profound Dharma,
and sharing the fluid of the consort —
may it be so, birth after birth.

Then the goddess, filled with joy, asked again these very words: "Sentient beings without fortune, those who are hard to tame — by what means can they be tamed?"

The Blessed One declared: "First, the restoration ceremony is to be given. After that, the ten bases of training — teach these, showing the Particularist (Vaibhāṣika) school. Likewise the Sūtra school. Then the Yogācāra itself. After

that, teach the Middle Way. Having fully understood the entire sequential order of mantra, thereafter take up Hevajra. The disciple who receives this with reverence — there is no doubt that accomplishment will arise."

This is the eighth chapter of the Hevajra Tantra, the chapter on taming.

Then the true characteristics of the union — of joining — were fully explained. Through mere consciousness of that by which a sādḥaka obtains siddhi: at the root of the navel of the object of practice, touch with the hand of one who holds the vow. Through the equanimous yoga of Heruka, with a mind that is internally unruly — by merely meditating on this, even a buddha is certainly destroyed. One who harms the teaching and destroys the guru who is a buddha — having requested this of the guru who is the Mighty One, it is to be done by slaying with compassion. Just as when one sees the form of cattle, one vomits blood, and the hair of the head stands loose and trembling — visualize with the face pointing downward. On that path, a needle of fire in form — imagine it entering there. At the heart, fixing on the seed of the venom-eater, one slays in an instant.

In this tantra there is no burning or pouring, no binding of mudrās, and no such acts. By the reading of the great tantra alone, accomplishment arises. Through meditation alone, it will be attained. The one who bestows non-conceptual siddhi — the secret supreme, delightful in purifying existence, is to be taught. Listen, fair-faced goddess!

Look, goddess, at the garland blazing with the splendor of precious gems, all stirred about. Without penetration, the union is undone. Through penetration, joy is bestowed.

Thus the precious thing possessed of five qualities that is desired in saṃsāra — in the impure it becomes poison; in the pure it becomes like nectar.

Heruka in the form of saṃsāra, the foremost one who liberates beings — whose form it is that undergoes transformation, that I shall now declare. Listen! The eyes of compassion are red; the limbs of the mind of loving-kindness are dark. By means of the four means of attraction, the feet are spoken of as fourfold. Eight faces — the eight liberations. Hands — the sixteen emptinesses. Through the hook-pose, the five buddhas. Wrathful in form to tame the vicious. The flesh is called the Pukkasī. Likewise blood is the Śmaśāna woman. The Caṇḍālī is called the fluid. The maidservant — the fat and the tendons. The skin — the seven limbs of awakening. The bones — the four truths.

Nairātmyā beseeched: "How is the collection of mantras to be made? By whose mantra does the activity-siddhi of people arise? May great bliss speak!"

The Blessed One, the Great Vajrin, the vajra-essence of great splendor, declared: "I shall explain the mantras to you. Great wisdom goddess, listen! First give Vairocana. In the midst of the ḍākinī of the Uṣmā ones, pressed by the Pukkasī with emptiness, at the end add Svāhā to the white syllable. By reciting this one hundred thousand times, one causes beings to be perpetually enraptured. First place the lord of syllables. Then from that sky-farer, with Svāhā affixed at the end — even the buddhas are brought under sway. Give the first of the mantric knowledge-holders. To the first add the second, with the thousandfold and Svāhā affixed at the end — by this one possessed of wisdom, even a buddha can be expelled. First give Vairocana. To the second add the third —"

adorned with horns and water-mothers, complete with the thousandfold and Svāhā — this causes all people to feel aversion. First place the lord of syllables. To the third of the fifth itself, add the empty ḍākinī; at the end place Svāhā — this is of great wrathful power. Then give the chief of syllables. Hūṃ, resembling blood, with Svāhā at the end — the supreme bindu — perpetually summons Gasmari and the like. First give the delusion family. Join Ghu correctly; with Svāhā added at the end, this kills gods and men. First place Vairocana. To the first of the first, join the vajra ḍākinī. To the second that rests at the end, add the vajra ḍākinī. Or at the tip of the first, add the vajra ḍākinī. To the third that rests at the end, again add that very one, complete. Above, adorned by the Caṇḍālī. After that, join with Hrīḥ; even seeing it, Svāhā itself is the practice. This is the mantra of Kurukullā. Oṃ — first, the fourth of the first, adorned by Caṇḍālī; to the fourth that is sung at the end, join Picuvajra; to the fourth of the Uṣmā ones, adorned by Pukkasī, pressed by emptiness, becoming triple — the second of the fifth, and the first of the third, with Svāhā at the end. This is the heart-mantra of Hevajra. First place Vairocana; join two of Jvāla; then to the fourth of the fifth, with the first of those that rest at the end, adorned by Ghasmarī; to the fourth of the Uṣmā ones, adorned by the vajra ḍākinī, pressed by emptiness, becoming triple — the second of the fifth, and the first of the third, with Svāhā at the end. This is the mantra of the four-armed one. First, Vairocana; the first — adorned with the inner white one; to the first of the third itself, adorned with the inner white one; becoming double, the third of the fifth and the third of the second, adorned with fire; joining the triple form of Hūṃ; the second of the fifth itself

and the first of the third, with Svāhā at the end. This is the mantra of the six-armed one. First, the fourth of Vairocana — the first, complete with the Byin-za; adorned by Ro-langs-ma; to the third that rests at the end, adorned by Ghasmaṛī; to the first of the first, the first that rests at the end, adorned by Vajrā; Kṣa adorned by Caṇḍālī; the first of the fifth itself and the fourth of the Uṣmā ones, adorned by the vajra ḍākinī, pressed by emptiness, becoming triple; Phaṭ, and at the end Svāhā itself. This is the mantra of the two-armed one. Nairātmyā — the first of the first; the first of the second itself; the first of the third itself; the first of the fourth; the first of the fifth; the first of those that rest at the end; the very first of the Uṣmā ones; first Vairocana, with Svāhā at the end. The recitation of the mantra for agitating a city is one hundred thousand times. The second of those that rest at the end, and Kṣa doubled; combined with the triple form of Hūṃ; first Vairocana, with Phaṭ — its inner form inserted — with Svāhā at the end. This is the mantra for purifying the ground. First Vairocana, then at the border of Vajrā, Hūṃ. This is for consecrating food and drink. First Vairocana itself, then Akāromukhaṃ; the third of the Uṣmā ones and the fourth that rests at the end, above adorned with fire; Dharmāṇāṃ, then Vajrā; Byinladrānupannātvāt; Oṃ Āḥ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā. This is the mantra for the torma of all elemental spirits.

This is the ninth chapter of Hevajra, the chapter on gathering mantras.

Then, the single summary of all phenomena —

It is declared: Vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva).

Having performed the milk-rite for Nairātmyā (Skt. nairātmyā, "the Selfless One"),

classify clearly the domains of recitation:

For pacification — recitation performed with crystal.

For power — red sandalwood itself.

For fierce activity — luṅtang.

For aversion, with niram and śu — for the rite of driving away, horse bone with Bam itself.

For summoning — brahmin bone itself.

For rain — elephant bone.

For killing — with mahīya as well.

Drinking crystal and milk is itself

to be employed for power according to one's own intention.

For killing — śīhala itself.

For invoking — the four as equal.

For aversion — recite "born of rice."

For driving away — recite "resin."

Or, alternatively: the initial Śva; the initial Śva and Na; the initial Ga; and the initial Ha — these are likewise employed in the same way.

This is the tenth chapter of Hevajra, the chapter on recitation.

Embracing Hevajra and pressing the lips together with the teeth, Nairātmyā asked concerning the family-forms of embodied beings. Having placed the liṅga in the bhaga, the guide of the wheel spoke thus: "O embodied beings, hear of your own family. Listen, O Perfection of Wisdom!

At the ring-finger's root — whether of a woman or a man — where the vajra has become nine-pointed: that is the supreme family of Akṣobhya (Skt. akṣobhya, the Imperturbable); it becomes the wheel of Vairocana; the one born of the lotus of the protector Amitābha; the Jewel of the family of Ratnasambhava; and the sword of the karma family.

Whatever yogin is greatly dark — his deity is Akṣobhya.

Whatever yogin is greatly white — his deity is Vairocana.

Whatever yogin is greatly blue-green — his deity is Amoghasiddhi (Skt. amoghasiddhi, the Unfailing Accomplisher).

Whatever yogin is greatly yellow — Ratnādhipa (the Lord of Jewels) is the deity of the family.

Whatever yogin is white-red — Amitābha is the deity of the family.

Whatever yogin is white and yellow — that one belongs to the bodhisattva family.

One who has brought yoga to its culmination: pride is not to be broken, the topknot not to be bound. Abiding in conventional form, these ones belong to the Sugata family.

The characteristic of women is exactly the same as that of men. By the conventional manner of nomenclature, one also belongs to that same family.

Having performed the milk-rite in the bhaga, the great Vajra was pleased with her, and Nairātmyā brought it to understanding. Listen — the goddess is to be worshipped supremely:

In a forest, in a deserted place, or within one's own home, one is to perform the great mudrā in nakedness and worship always with yogic awareness. Having performed the milk-rite and the embrace, touching the bhaga in the

same way, pinching the man's nose, drinking the honey of the lips — always from the sign of intoxication, acting with the hand in the manner of holding, and what is called khyog and brala, and similarly what is called "fully loaded": again and again, the vajra performs what is desired. Looking upward and downward — by this, vast accomplishment is obtained and one becomes equal to all buddhas. Camphor is to be drunk in that, and on account of the camphor, flesh too is to be eaten, and in particular wine itself.

This is the eleventh chapter of Hevajra, called "The Chapter on the Meaning of the Practice of Innate Union."

Then the Vajra-holder declared verses on the fourth empowerment (Skt. abhiṣeka):

Dwelling as the vajra, as vajra itself,
holding the great bell and vajra,
today you become the vajra master —
gather disciples to yourself.
Just as the buddhas of the past
conferred empowerment upon the bodhisattva heirs,
so I, through the secret empowerment,
confer empowerment through the stream of mind.

O goddess Joyous-giver, O fire, O place-giver,
O variously-formed and beautiful one —
carry, carry, O great bodhisattva!
Carry her and perform the worship purely.

This wisdom is supremely subtle,
like the vajra in the midst of space —
dust-free, liberation-giving, peace itself —
you yourself are its very essence.

The mantra for the blessing of the vajra and lotus is:

Om paṭmu sukhādhāra mahārāga sukhaṃ dad catvārānanda bhāga piśva hūṃ
hūṃ hūṃ kāryaṃ kuru śva me. Om vajra mahādveṣa caturānanda dāyakaḥ
khagamukhaikara sonātha hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ kāryaṃ kuru śva me.

At the crown of the head is the form of Oṃ; at the heart is the form of Hūṃ; at the navel is the form of Āḥ.

This concludes the King of the Great Tantras, the Tantra of the Magical Examination, drawn from the thirty-two examinations — the King of Tantras of

the vow of the net of the dākinī hero-vajra, the essence of the two examinations.

This was translated, corrected, and definitively established from the oral transmission of the Indian master Gayādhara by the Tibetan translator, the monk Śākya Yeshe. It was subsequently revised, completed where the translation had been interrupted, and refined by the translator Gzhon-nu-dpal.

Translator's Notes

- The opening numerals refer to the prescribed numbers of repetitions of fire offerings for different classes of beings or practitioners: seven hundred thousand for asuras, two hundred thousand for gods, one hundred thousand for mantra practitioners. These colophon-like lines appear to conclude a section of fire-offering instructions before the next chapter begins.

The Sanskrit mantras and ritual phrases have been transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan. The phrase "ma-ma rincen natstso dzin" is rendered by its semantic meaning as "holder of varied jewels," which reflects a name or epithet of the goddess being invoked.

The phrase rendered as "the water of welcome and foot-washing" translates mchod yon zhabs bsil, the standard pair of first offerings in the eightfold ritual offering sequence.

"Drawing in by fire" and "the fire's delight" are ritual labels for mantra functions in the homa context.

- The term rendered "vajra-essence" in the opening verse is a title or epithet referring to the deity Vajrasattva or the text's speaker; the Tibetan "rdo rje snying po" can also simply mean "the vajra-heart / essence," used self-referentially by the speaking deity.

The line rendered "the kakkolā plant reside the center" refers to a tantric anatomical visualization in which the breast is reinterpreted as a plant or body part; "kakkolā" is a specific aromatic plant used in tantric ritual contexts, and the imagery here is part of the visualization of the female body being transformed into the body of Heruka.

"Sihla" and "karpūra" are specific substances — saffron and camphor respectively — used in tantric ritual; "si hla" in Tibetan transcribes Sanskrit "sīhla" (saffron), and "ga bur" transcribes "karpūra" (camphor). The translation renders these with Sanskrit terms in parentheses for clarity.

The final list of colored blisses is left without a closing grammatical resolution because the Tibetan passage ends mid-enumeration, suggesting this is a continuation that breaks off here.

- The passage is from a tantric text in the completion-stage yoginītantra tradition, presenting the teaching of Vajrahṛdaya and the Blessed One in a scholastic dialogue format followed by a declaration in the first person. The first-person speech attributed to the bhaga of the vajra-queen is a standard tantric literary device presenting the fundamental reality as self-declaring.

The term bola and kakkola are Sanskrit botanical or ritual substances used in tantric contexts. They are kept as proper names since they function as technical terms in the five-element correlation system described here.

The phrase rendered "vital essence" for khu ba glosses a term that can mean semen, vital fluid, or bindu in tantric physiology. The doctrinal point here is the identification of the bindu with the

Teacher's physical marks, a standard Vajrayāna correlation.

The phrase "wind-disorder" renders the classical Indic medical concept of a condition caused by disordered wind-energy, and the remedy involving dark-seed legumes is a conventional Āyurvedic reference preserved here in its medical sense.

- The syllables E and Vam are technical tantric seed-syllables foundational to the Hevajra Tantra. E conventionally symbolizes the wisdom of emptiness, often associated with the female principle and the womb of awakening; Vam represents the method or bliss aspect, associated with the male principle. Together as "Evam" they form the tantra's opening word and encode its central non-dual doctrine of bliss and emptiness. The passage is from the Hevajra Tantra, and the chapter colophon confirms this as Chapter Two of that text.

The "four moments" — variety, ripening, freedom from ripening, and freedom from defining characteristics — are a standard fourfold schema in the Hevajra cycle corresponding to four types of bliss experienced in tantric practice. The "wisdom of sixteen" refers to the sixteen measures or degrees of the lunar digit, a standard metaphor in this tradition for the fullness of blissful awareness.

- The phrase rendered "the supreme wine of the vine" translates a term that likely refers to a ritual intoxicant or fermented grape beverage used in tantric feast-offerings; the precise compound is somewhat compressed and the reading follows the most contextually coherent interpretation.

The syllables "bo and ka" in the maṇḍala-wheel explanation are Tantric seed syllables; their precise referents in this textual tradition are not specified in the passage itself. This is a genuine doctrinal ambiguity that would require recourse to a root commentary to resolve.

The passage on the vow reverses the ordinary meaning of the pratimokṣa precepts — killing, lying, stealing, and sexual misconduct — reinterpreting them esoterically through tantric antinomian hermeneutics; the translation preserves the literal structure of the reinterpretation without smoothing it.

- The "intentional language" or "twilight language" (Skt. sandhyābhāṣā) section contains a series of coded terms in a Middle Indic or mixed Sanskrit register. The transcription from Tibetan of these loanwords is phonologically approximate and the underlying Indic forms are not always recoverable with certainty. The renderings given here follow the most plausible reconstructions from the tantric lexicographic tradition; a specialist reader should consult parallel Sanskrit witnesses where available.

The term rendered "self-arisen" in the coded-language list (Tib. rang byung, expressed as sigra) likely refers to self-arisen flowers or substances found without human cultivation, a common tantric category.

The list of social classes touched without discrimination — servant-women, outcastes, hide-tanners, washerwomen, brahmins, kṣatriyas, minor lords, and commoners — reflects the antinomian transgression of caste hierarchy characteristic of this genre of tantric literature.

- The long passage of transliterated syllables in the middle of this text is a dhāraṇī or ritual formula rendered phonetically into Tibetan script from what appears to be a Prakrit or Apabhraṃśa language, as is typical of early tantric texts of this class. These syllables have no recoverable semantic translation and are here rendered as a faithful phonetic transcription into Roman script. Individual syllable clusters may represent deity names, seed-syllables, or terms in the "twilight language" discussed in this very chapter, but attempting translation would be speculative.

The phrase "sixteen and two" in the chapter-on-families section likely refers to the thirty-two or the sixteen subsidiary aspects of the vajra-family system, but the precise referent is not determinable from this passage alone without broader textual context.

The term rendered "sleeping woman," "dancing woman," "self-arisen woman," "twice-born," and "dyed woman" are technical designations for the five mudrā consorts correlated to the five buddha families, carried over from the vocabulary list in the preceding passage.

- The Tibetan text ends mid-sentence with "From the yoga of the completion stage," indicating the passage breaks off and continues beyond what was provided here.

The term rendered "zombie woman" translates ro-langs-ma, literally "risen corpse woman," a stock figure in these tantric lists of yoginī types; "zombie" is used to convey this to a general listener.

"Pukkasī" and "Ghasmarī" are left in Sanskrit-derived transliteration as they are proper names of specific tantric yoginī figures, not transparent descriptors.

"Twice sixteen" refers to the thirty-two channels (nāḍīs) in tantric physiology, each associated with a yoginī. The "sixteen fractions" of the moon refer to the sixteen phases of the lunar cycle, which in this context map onto the sixteen vowels and the drops of awakening mind — a standard Hevajra Tantra doctrinal framework.

"Evaṃ" is left untranslated as it is a technical seed-syllable pair of great significance in this tantra, representing the union of wisdom and method.

The "kokkola" and "bo" in the context of the practice description are technical tantric terms referring to the physical constituents involved in the rite; the language here is deliberately euphemistic and encoded.

- The phrase "bo la'i bde ba" rendered as "the great bliss of the bo" follows the preceding passage's own usage of "bo" (likely a seed-syllable or technical term of the completion-stage yoga); the translation preserves it as in the prior rendering.

The phrase "rnam pa bzhi" rendered as "fourfold" refers to the four fruits, which in this tantric context likely means the four kāyas or the four joys; the precise referent is not specified in the text and so is left as "fourfold" without gloss.

The final line "zla ba bcu yangs rnam yin" — "they are those in the ten full months" — refers to the ten months of gestation; the tantric usage here is drawing an analogy between the gestational process and the stages of spiritual ripening.

- The eight goddesses listed at the opening include Parṇaśavarī, here rendered "wilderness-dweller" when she reappears in the element-mudrā dialogue; the Tibetan ri khrod ma means "she of the mountain hermitage or forest," which corresponds to Parṇaśavarī. This is consistent.

The term rendered "worms of excrement" (bshang ba'i srin bu) is a standard example of lowly life forms used in Tantric literature to indicate the universality of buddha-nature.

The passage breaks off mid-verse at the end of the supplied Tibetan; the final two lines are incomplete as given.

- The mantra passages are transliterated strings of Sanskrit and Apabhraṃśa phonemes embedded in the Tibetan text; they are preserved as phonetic transcriptions in the translation since they function as dhāraṇī-mantras, not as prose to be rendered semantically.

The term rendered "singer woman" follows the preceding passage's context for gsungmo, a feminine figure associated with speech and song in the Hevajra system.

The phrase རྒྱལ་སྐོར་གྲིང་པོ་འདྲི་བ་ཀླུ་མ་ཡོད་པའི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་ཤིང་། in Vajragarbha's question is rendered "the chief one I have not previously sought to know," following the interpretive convention that bdag gis sngar ma tshol means the questioner confesses prior ignorance of this particular teaching; an alternative reading would be "I have not previously asked the chief one," which amounts to the same doctrinal point.

- The term rendered as "zombie woman" is *vetālinī* in Sanskrit, a female *vetāla* — a being that animates corpses; the Tibetan *ro lang*s *ma* carries this sense precisely.

The phrase "pair of drinkers" translates a Tibetan expression indicating pairs who drink from skull-cups; the exact identities of the eight skull sequences follow a tantric enumeration and the translation preserves the structural logic without importing commentary.

The syllable string GĀṂ CĀṂ BĀṂ GHĀṂ ŚĀṂ CĀṂ LĀṂ ḌĀṂ is a bīja-mantra sequence transliterated directly; the Tibetan preserves the Sanskrit phonetics and no translation of individual syllables is appropriate here.

The term rendered "the destroyer and the wealth-giver" (Tibetan *mthar byed dang nor sbyin*) likely refers to Yama and Vaiśravaṇa or to analogous tantric symbolic figures presiding over the left skull-cups; the identification is contextual.

- The names Ghasmaṛī, Pukkaṣī, and related figures are tantric goddess names drawn from the Hevajra and related Yoginī-tantra cycles; they are rendered as transliterations throughout. "Zombie woman" renders the tantric deity class vetālinī, a corpse-raising female figure. The line "the cool-maker" in the forest woman's left hand likely refers to a fan or similar cooling implement; the Tibetan bsil byed is a standard term for such an object. The phrase "resembles the former sovereign" for Pukkaṣī is a compressed expression for a past royal figure associated with a past empowerment or overlordship. "Gypsy woman" for gYung mo or ḍombī is a conventional rendering for this outcaste tantric figure. The mantra syllables and Sanskrit epithets in the dhāraṇī passage are rendered as close transliterations of the Tibetan phonetic transcription; the Sanskrit underlying forms have been restored where recoverable. The "śarabha" is a mythological eight-legged beast; in tantric maṇḍala iconography it is a standard directional symbol. The ḍamaru drum is the standard reading for "cang te'u" in this context.
- The passage contains explicit tantric sexual yoga terminology throughout, rendered as faithfully as possible within readable English. The "eight vidyās" or consorts enumerated by family relationship (mother, sister, daughter, younger sister, wife of uncle, mother's kinswoman, aunt, father's sister) reflect a standard Hevajra Tantra listing and are rendered according to their literal Tibetan meaning, noting that these are understood within the tradition as symbolic or actual ritual partners depending on the commentarial interpretation.

The term "bola" and "kakkolā" are left in transliteration as they refer to specific ritual or pharmacological substances (likely resins or aromatic compounds) whose exact identification is uncertain in context.

The phrase rendered as "the two waves of enjoyment" translates a technical phrase for the two streams of bindu or vital essence engaged in the sexual yoga practice; the precise physiological referent is deliberately obscure in the original.

The line "free from joy, bounded at its extreme" and the closing description of Heruka as "empty and non-empty" reflect the intentional paradoxical style (*sandhābhāṣā*, twilight language) characteristic of the Hevajra Tantra, and no single transparent doctrinal rendering fully resolves the ambiguity — this is deliberate in the tradition.

- The term *mālatīndānam* is a transliteration of a Sanskrit compound left untranslated in the Tibetan itself; its precise referent as a *samaya* substance is uncertain in the commentarial literature and is rendered here in transliteration as in the original.

The phrase rendered "a king and master of Śālu" is obscure; Śālu (Sanskrit śālu or śāli) may refer to a type of rice, in which case the meaning may be "one who is supreme in the food of rice," pointing to a ritual food substance rather than a royal title. This is a genuinely contested reading.

The phrase "bolla and kakkolā" in the continuation passage refers to specific tantric substances or plants; they are retained in transliteration following the source text.

The closing verse "Born into the lineage and bound by samaya — teach Hevajra without madness" is terse and may function as a gatekeeper instruction: Hevajra is to be transmitted only to those of proper lineage, proper samaya-commitment, and stable mind.

- The passage describing "slaying with compassion" is a standard antinomian tantric topos referring to the ritual killing of one who destroys the Dharma or the guru-buddha relationship; the phrase "having requested the guru who is the Mighty One" indicates the act requires the guru's sanction and is framed as a compassionate act. This should not be read literally outside its tantric ceremonial and doctrinal context.

The term rendered "Uṣmā ones" refers to a class of tantric female figures associated with heat or warmth; the exact Sanskrit is preserved as Uṣmā because the Tibetan is a direct transliteration.

The final lines break off mid-sentence, as this is a continuous textual extract; the passage continues beyond what is given here.

- This passage consists almost entirely of tantric mantra-construction instructions, encoding Hevajra and related mantras through a cipher system that identifies syllables by family group, position, and various modifier ḍākinīs and consonants. The terms "Caṇḍālī," "Ghasmarī," "Ro-langs-ma," and "Byin-za" refer to specific tantric deity-consorts or ḍākinī figures within the Hevajra maṇḍala whose syllabic associations unlock the encoded mantra text. Full decipherment requires access to the corresponding commentary tradition. The epithets "four-armed," "six-armed," and "two-armed" refer to specific forms of Hevajra. "Nairātmyā" here functions both as the name of the consort deity and as the first element of a mantra sequence.

- The identification of specific substances and rites in the first section — such as "luṅtang" and "niram śu" — reflects mantra-ritual terminology that is either proper names or transcriptions of substances not fully resolved in standard lexica; they are rendered as transliterations rather than guesses.

The phrase rendered "the four as equal" for "bzhimnyam" in the context of summoning likely refers to a ritual employment of four equal elements or four substances, but the precise referent is not specified in the text.

The terms "khyog" and "brala" in the sexual yoga section are technical euphemisms for specific physical postures or movements in the inner yogic practice; their precise referents are conventional within the tantric context but are not transparent from the syllables alone, and so they are left transliterated.

"Mahīya" is an uncertain term — possibly a transcription of a Sanskrit word for a particular substance or creature used in the killing rite; it is rendered as given in the Tibetan.

- The mantra strings are reproduced as transliterated Sanskrit syllables without semantic rendering, which is standard for mantra passages in this literature. The Sanskrit reconstruction of these mantras is partially legible but the full liturgical interpretation of individual syllables falls outside the scope of a philological translation note.

The colophon names the Indian paṇḍita Gayādhara, a well-attested figure active in Tibet in the eleventh century, and two Tibetan translators: Śākya Yeshe and Gzhon-nu-dpal, the latter completing and polishing a translation left unfinished by the former.

The phrase rendered "hero-vajra" translates kyai-rdo-rje, a standard Tibetan rendering of the tantric deity Hevajra; it has been left in descriptive form here to preserve the flow of the text without introducing a deity name not previously established in this passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.